



Dinesh Virwani
Executive Vice Chairman
Epic Group

Ranjan Mahtani
Founder & Chairman
Epic Group

Sunil Daryanani
Executive Vice Chairman
Epic Group

Major global buyers stayed with the group because it consistently delivers quality, reliability, innovation, sustainability standards, and execution. Epic's relationship with Walmart, in particular, illustrates how the company has grown by deepening trust rather than merely chasing volumes. From the first direct orders secured from Bentonville in 1997, the relationship expanded into dedicated manufacturing capacity in Bangladesh, a large women's empowerment initiative with CARE Bangladesh, and a first-sale duty savings program that reportedly generated close to US\$100 million in savings for the customer over time. That isn't the profile of a commodity supplier; it is the profile of a sophisticated partner that customers are eager to build with. Aly Ansari, Head of Sourcing - Asia at Walmart, describes Epic as "a premium strategic partner" and notes that "we have a very long-term relationship and have been growing together with each other." On sustainability, Ansari is unequivocal:

"I would score Epic 10 out of 10 regarding sustainability and environmental protection, which is significantly higher than other OEMs." Ansari also highlights Epic's agility: "Epic collaborated with us on a domestic replenishment model for certain styles, which only very few strategic suppliers can support as they need to make additional investments. It really helps us to mitigate increasing geopolitical risks while maintaining balance between price and quality."

Epic's story has similar markers elsewhere. It went on to secure business from Fast Retailing and Uniqlo—a relationship that signals the group's ability to meet exacting standards in quality, manufacturing discipline, and customer service. Senior executive at Uniqlo, emphasizes the cultural fit: "I think they're very hands-on management. The top management team, from the chairman to everyone, is very hands-on and that's what we like. Because we are a Japanese company, we are very

hands-on and non-bureaucratic. So we see that there is a lot of similarity. They are very excellence-oriented, futuristic. Overall the matching is good." senior executive at Uniqlo also notes that "Epic is as serious as we are in terms of serving the end customers. Their New York office shares trend ideas regarding fabric selection and customer preferences." On sustainability, the executive confirms that "Epic ranks among the top suppliers in sustainability metrics, with achievements in carbon reduction, clean-air factories, green energy usage, worker education, and social welfare programs."

Sunil Daryanani, Vice Chairman, reflects on what these relationships represent: "Our relationships with customers like Walmart and Uniqlo weren't built overnight. They were earned through decades of consistent delivery, transparency, and willingness to invest ahead of demand. That's the same approach we're taking in India. Bhubaneswar represents a long-term bet on India - not just a sourcing destination, but as a manufacturing and innovation hub that customers want to grow with." This transition expanded the enterprise's scale and altered its identity. Today, Epic is not merely a garment maker. The International Finance Corporation (IFC), part of the World Bank Group, in announcing its 2024 financing package for the group, described Epic as offering world-class manufacturing, design, creativity, replenishment, and inventory management solutions. Epic's own profile reinforces this: it highlights design services, including a New York design studio, with designers operating across New York, Hong Kong, and London, while its sales footprint spans Hong Kong, Dubai, and New York. For Brian Deleu, President of Design & Development, the point is that "design today must do more than anticipate trends; it has to connect creativity with sustainability, speed, data, and manufacturability." He argues this is where "Epic's global studio model gives it an edge."

Epic is now positioned in a higher league than a conventional apparel exporter or manufacturer. It participates not only in production but also gradually in product conception, market response, and supply-chain design. The showrooms and design presence in New York and London, supported by Hong Kong, give the company greater relevance in sustainable and value-added fashion than a mere manufacturing label would imply. As Anurag Asthana, Chief Sales & Marketing Officer, says, "Customers today do not want a vendor at the end of the chain. They want a partner who can read demand, shape product and respond with speed." That is precisely how Epic has repositioned itself. Yvonne Fung, Head of Merchandising, describes

